

Basic Teachings Of Islam



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SHARES

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This text presents the essential beliefs and practices of Islam within the Shiʿa tradition. It begins with God's oneness and attributes, then explains the relationship between God, humanity, and the universe.

It addresses prophecy, knowledge, miracles, and the purpose of worship.

It discusses sin, repentance, fate, and free will, and explains life after death, paradise, and hell.

It also explores the harmony of reason and science with faith, offering clear guidance for living with devotion and understanding.

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Preface

In the Name of Allah

The present book is a part of the invaluable legacy of the martyr Ayatollah Dr. Beheshti. Despite its briefness, it successfully presents the principles and the outlines of Islamic code of behaviour.

The attractive comprehensiveness of the book together with the need to illuminate the high station of that great Islamic figure impelled the Islamic Propagation Organization to present a re-edition of the work which was first published by The Islamic Center of Hamburg.

Islamic Propagation Organization

International Relations Department

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Introduction

The Interest In Islam

Nowadays, a noticeable interest in Islam is being shown in many parts of the world. Many Muslims wish to know more about Islam and Non-Muslims wish to learn more of it for the first time. They inquire about the teachings of Islam, this great religion with millions of followers and its differentiation regarding other religions. This interest is visible among the youth of the West, especially in the many seminars held to study Islam, alone and/or comparatively.

Islamic Centre Of Hamburg

The Islamic Centre of Hamburg is set up to intensify this interest and to provide all interested people with better possibilities to understand Islam. This may be achieved by the publication of booklets in various languages which will make available the teachings of Islam to the inquiring minds of our time.

Therefore, we have decided to publish several brochures about the main subjects of Islam. They will Make, altogether, a comprehensive book about Islam. The first issue is published in English, German, Arabic, Turkish, and Persian. It contains a lecture given on Islam by the Imam of “Islamic Centre Hamburg” to the Epiphany Community Hamburg on October 14, 1965 and to the students 'Corps Rhenania.

Hamburg on October 29, 1965.

This is the beginning and we hope to continue our work with the help of God and the support of all those who are interested in such a great purpose.

Islamic Centre of Hamburg

Hamburg,

December 13, 1966 A. D., Ramazan I, 1386. A.H.

Basic Teachings Of Islam

In The Name Of God, The Merciful, The Gracious

Ladies and gentlemen,

Let me greet first those who— free from arrogance and prejudice—seek the truth, those who humble themselves in its presence regardless of what the truth may be, those who do not blindly oppose it when it requires apprehension and when it ought to be embraced. Those who carefully and wisely investigate each problem and having in good conscience evaluated it follow nothing but the best. The Holy Qur'an says:

“And thus, preach joy to My servants” (39: 17).

“Those who listen to the word and follow the best of it. Those are the ones whom Allah has guided and they are the wise people” (39: 18).

You have invited me to talk to you about Islam today. The actual reason seems to be that you have heard of “Islam” and thereby have been urged to seek further knowledge and learn of its truth. Let me give you good tidings: should you set out on this highway with sincerity and thus follow it. The gateway of a true understanding of Islam will be opened up to you and you shall pursue your course smoothly. I shall attempt in a short talk to explain the cornerstone of Islamic teachings and some of its fundamental features. It will be your turn to consider matters carefully and if you come across anything you would like to understand more thoroughly, do not hesitate to set forth your questions.

The subject will be much clarified in the process of question and answer. In order to banish any lingering restraint, you may have at question time, let me tell you that I am as keen to hear you as you are at the moment to hear me. May I finally add that what I may relate about Islam is confined to the results of my personal inquiries, and that I have not' relied upon inherited beliefs and dogmas or upon the ideas of other thinkers.

I have primarily relied upon the Holy Qur'an, which is the sacred text of all Muslims, a book revealed to Muhammad so that it may be available to all men at all times and is the most fundamental source of acquaintance with Islam, a book which in myriads of copies has been available to all peoples throughout the centuries. The question results, if one can rely on a better and more trustworthy source to get acquainted with Islam.

If we are of the opinion that The Holy Qur'an can be considered the most important Islamic source, it does not mean that other sources, for example Hadith (statements or actions of the prophet. handed down to us), are absolutely of no value. There is no doubt that a remarkable portion of Islamic teachings ought to be understood by means of these sources. But Hadith and similar sources are only valuable, if they report truly on statements or actions of the Prophet Muhammad.

Doubtful traditions are therefore no acceptable source to us. In order that the false and doubtful traditions exercise no disadvantageous influence on Islam, the principles of this religion demand all traditions Hadith etc – be first compared with Koran, thus eliminating such relevant points which do not comply. Therefore, everybody who wants to realize a true investigation of Islam and its principles must consequently first thoroughly know The Holy Qur'an in each and every respect and compare each and every theme in tradition, history and similar fields with the same.

Only One God

The cornerstone of Islam is "Tauhid". i.e. monotheism. "Tauhid" means belief in only one God and that existence in general– among other things the order of nature– is a manifestation of His grand design, as well as turning to God in prayer and glorification, away from worshipping any other.

The first article of faith is:

"La ilaha illa-Allah" – "There is no God but Allah." and the first step towards Islam:

"Ash-hadu an la ilalha illa-Allah" – "I testify that there is no God but Allah".

Not only my tongue but also my heart and inner light all proclaim that there is no other than the Creator of the world who is worthy of adoration.

All the other teachings of Islam are founded upon this and have their source here. Accordingly, Islam proclaimed monotheism to be the path to salvation.

"Qulu la ilaha illa Allah, tuflihu" "Say: There is no God but Allah, and thereby you will attain salvation".

This means:

Say and act sincerely, and believe with all your heart that apart from the only Creator of the world there is nothing worthy of adoration and this shall be your path to salvation.

Correct Knowledge Of God

Islam has attached importance, more than anything else, to the proper knowledge of God, free from any aberration. It is chiefly here that Islam is outstanding. Consequently, in the course of my talk which will have to be a basis for your future acquaintance with Islam, I shall attend to this feature.

The Invisible God

The only God to Whom Islam invites everyone is inaccessible to the senses. He is beyond the reach of eyesight nor is He open to touch. The Holy Qur'an says in this respect:

“No vision can grasp Him but His grasp is over all vision. He is above all comprehension yet Omniscient” (6: 103).

Vision does not penetrate beyond colour and figure but God has neither one nor the other. His glory is beyond the reach of vision and other senses in general.

God Unlike Anything Else

We generally have a mental picture of things we know, for example: flowers and fruits, hills and dales, sun, moon and stars and human beings as well. But what about God? Can we also form an image. of Him? Never!

Because our notions are a result of our experiences, or constructions out of our experiences or of analysis carried on by our restless mind, yet having their roots in things we have come to know through our senses.

In this respect The Holy Qur'an says:

“The Creator of the heavens and of the earth, He has created pairs of yourselves as well as pairs of the animals- thereby He multiplies you. Nothing is like unto Him and He is, the All-hearing, the All seeing” (42: 11).

Yes, God can be represented neither in form of a painting nor a statue. He can also not be conceived.

God, The Omniscient, The Mighty

On various occasions, The Holy Qur'an mentions different and absolute attributes for God:

He is the Creator^{[1](#)}; the Omniscient^{[2](#)}; the All hearing^{[3](#)}; the All-seeing^{[4](#)}; the All-guiding^{[5](#)}; the Supporter^{[6](#)}; the Forbearing^{[7](#)}; the Amiable^{[8](#)}; the Always- forgiving^{[9](#)}, the Self-sufficient^{[10](#)}.

A God who knows our most secret thoughts^{[11](#)}, listens to the prayers of all His servants^{[12](#)}, grants each and everyone his due^{[13](#)}.

A God who is nearer and more gracious to us than any other being^{[14](#)}.

Praise Of God

Since man's mind has more to do with relative ideas, that is to say his ideas are of relative things, even in the understanding of those of His attributes which the Holy Qur'an mentions, man is liable to go astray and fall into error. It is owing to this shortcoming of the human mind that there are many verses in the Holy Qur'an which attribute to God purity from imperfections which have their seat in the native deficiency of our thoughts.

Has God Any Children?

Among these erroneous ideas is the notion that God has children. There are people who believe that Jesus peace be with him– is the son of God. There have also been people and perhaps there still are, who fancy that angels are God's daughters. In this respect the Holy Qur'an says:

“... and they falsely, having no knowledge, attributed to Him sons and daughters. Praise and glory to Him! He is far above whatever they attributed to Him” (6: 100).

“The Creator of the heavens and the earth, wherefrom could He have a child. when He has no consort? And He has Created everything and knows everything” (6: 101).

“That is God. your Lord! There is no God but He. the Creator of all things. Then worship Him and He is the Guardian of all things” (6: 102).

“And they say: ‘Allah begot a son’. Praise and glory be to Him! Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on the earth, everything renders worship to Him” (2: 116).

The Holy Qur'an warns us against considering angels and apostles as God's offspring. They are His bondsmen, though admittedly eminent among them. But by no means may they be considered as His children. Adam, Noah, Abraham, Lot, Hud, Saleh, Ismael, Isaac, Jacob, Shoaib, Moses Joshua, Enoch, John, Jesus, Muhammad, and the other apostles are like us in so far as they are men and God's servants.

He has created them as He has created others. Should those who say that Jesus is God's son mean that God is a father as we are to our children, then their characterisation of Him is improper. God is elevated above such immature fancies. On the other hand, if they mean something different, they should use a different notion to express it, rather than the misleading term “Son of God”

The Danger Of Comparison (Anthropomorphism)

Using such expressions as “Son of God” always involves the danger of the only God, to Whom nothing is alike, appearing to men as a magnified human being living beyond the clouds. This is the danger of

anthropomorphism which is a stumbling block on the path of a correct acquaintance with God deviating the course of men's thinking.

The unfounded and fanciful beliefs of many believers and the weak objections made by many agnostics and atheists are nearly entirely the result of these unfitting ideas which are in turn produced by the anthropomorphising imagination of man. Believers create in their fancy something they call God and worship this image and unbelievers considering this product find it an idea without any foundation and thereupon reject to believe in His existence at all. But truly, both are in error. The only God to Whom Islam invites all men to believe and to worship is neither this nor that but far above such false images.

It is for these considerations that one of the primary teachings of Islam is a total abstinence from comparison (anthropomorphism).

Islam And The Relation Between God, Man And The Universe

Islam considers a correct acquaintance with God as being related to a proper understanding of man and universe. According to its teachings the better our knowledge of man's nature and being the more perfect our knowledge of God and the truer.

"Whoever knows himself knows His Lord."

This also holds true of creation in general. A better understanding of the creatures is a real help towards better understanding of God, the Creator. On the other hand. any kind of deep-rooted error or unfounded fancy about man and universe, particularly God's relation to man, universe and to angels leads to an erroneous idea of God, the Maker because the knowledge of cause and effect are intimately related. [15](#)

It is easy to deduce from these verses the close correlation:

Recognition Of God/ Cognition Of Man And Universe

There are many verses in The Holy Qur'an inviting man to reflect upon himself and the universe in order to acquire a better understanding of God.

Thus, two pertinent verses of The Holy Qur'an read as follows:

"In the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding (definite) proof" (3: 190).

"Who think of Allah, standing, sitting and lying and think about the creation of the heavens and the earth..." (3: 191).

Man And Universe

Recognize yourself!

Islamic teachings say: “Oh man! O you, who from time to time forgets his noble station bowing down in fear to sun, moon, stars, mountain and wind. and in whose sight, they appear so great and powerful! O you. whose mind and soul have been conquered by the majesty and grandeur of the rich and mighty gaping at them in awe, taking them to be divine gods, worshipping them in humility and enslaving yourself to them! Wake up from your deep sleep! No earthly or heavenly thing has ascendancy over you! You have not recognised your worth and have cast yourself for no price at their feet! Arise! Learn of your strength with which God has endowed you and employ your faculties rightly! If you attend to God’s bidding, you will see that you are neither as little nor those as great as you fancy. “

Dominating Nature

Islam has openly proclaimed that man's true worth lies in the measure he has conquered nature and tamed it. The 20th verse of the 31st Sura reads as follows:

“Have you not seen that Allah has subjected to your (use) everything, all things in the heavens and on the earth and has made His bounties flow to you in exceeding measure, (both) seen and unseen?...” (31:20).

Moreover verses 32– 34 of the 14th Sura have the following wording:

“It is Allah who has created the heavens and the earth. sent down water from the sky, brought out fruits therewith to feed you rendered ships to your service that they may sail through the sea according to His will and He subjected streams and rivers to you” (14:32).

“And He has subjected sun and moon to you, both diligently pursuing their courses. And the day and the night has He subjected to you” (14:33).

“And He has given you of all that ye ask for. And if you count the favours of Allah, you won't be able to number them. Verily, man is unjust and ungrateful” (14:34).

These verses and many others point to the possibility of man to dominate nature. Fourteen centuries ago, man had progressed only so far as to control sheep and cattle, camel and elephant. He had learnt to use their milk and meat and hide, ride them or bear his cargo on their backs. He had learnt to conquer somehow the restless sea, ride its billows in small or large vessels and cross the seas with his merchandise. He had also learnt to harness turbulent rivers and by building dams or channelling off their angry water– drive them to serene orchards and fields.

But did man always have control of such things? There was a time when even such paltry things were

beyond his reach. On the contrary, fearing all or some of them, he could not muster courage to face them. In the course of time, he came to learn that he had no reason to fear them and casting off his irrational fear, his inner faculties opened up and in the light of labour and thought, he conquered and came to master them. Now the Holy Qur'an inspires man to consider his area of influence wider. Let man know that day and night. The sun, moon and stars and in a word Nature in all its majesty is awaiting his conquest, on condition that he does justice to himself and does not give in to ignorance and lust, on condition that he does not strike the wrong path but choose the straight road which God has set before him and that he be not thankless to his Creator.

Man And God!

Recognize yourself once again!

Although Islam inspires man with the fire of conquest, it warns him at the same time:

Oh man. let not your feeling of increasing strength lead to vanity, the other extremity of the middle way!

Once again consider yourself how, despite your might, you are like a bubble riding the seas. It will not be long before you lose your youth and freshness, your will to work and power to think. Despite your search for strength through art and science, from time to time you still suffer illness and weakness or old age and uselessness, so that you cannot drive away a mite from yourself. Do you know to what this change points? It points to the fact that though we spoke of your high station, you are part of the universe in which nothing owes its life to itself nor is anything in it everlasting, and everything in it is a ray of God the only lasting thing. independent of all else.

Hence, never banish from your soul the thought of Him, on Whom you depend for your life and your very existence. Make your bond with Him secure and attempt to get closer to Him.

Approaching God

How can we draw near to God?

God's perfection and existence know no bounds, while the existence of all other beings however, is relative.

The relative beings of our universe are on the path of evolution and through their inner light seek perfection. Seeking perfection is to search for God. The more one acquires relative perfection, the nearer he gets to God, the Absolutely Perfect.

Man is also one of those beings who of their inner light seek perfection, but however hard he may try he cannot cast off his relativity. He can but keep on the path and increase his measure of perfection and thus approach God, the Absolutely Perfect.

This is the true meaning of approaching God in Islam.

According to the teachings of Islam any act of worship in general may be considered as a means of approaching God only if it helps man on his path to perfection or maintains the development he has already attained.

Prayer

God is available to all men, at all times, in all places. Anyone may turn towards Him and seek His help. Verse 186, sura 2, reads as follows:

“And when My servants ask thee concerning Me: I am indeed close [to them]. I respond to the prayer of every petitioner, when he calls on Me” (2: 186).

The basic condition of prayer is that man turn to God in all sincerity. It is only that God will answer his prayer, regardless of time and place and needless of intercession.

Sin, Repentance And Remission

Sinners may also turn away from sin at any time and place and take the path of goodness and expect God's mercy and they need nothing and nobody else to have recourse to.

In this respect The Holy Qur'an says:

“Say: 'Oh, My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah. Allah forgives all sins- He is oft forgiving, most merciful” (39:53).

“Turn ye to your Lord (in repentance) and bow to His will, before the punishment comes on you, and ye shall not be helped any more” (39:54).

God And Universe

The universe and all it contains is a creation of God. The laws governing the universe, including the laws of nature, are God's laws and the ways and habits, ordained by Him. Among the verses of the Holy Qur'an, we find that events generally attributed to nature (and from one point of view this is true) are considered as God's work Verse 32, sura 14 says in this respect:

“It is Allah Who has created the heavens and the earth, sent down water from the sky, brought out fruits therewith to feed you, rendered ships to your service that they may sail through the sea according to His will and He subjected streams and rivers to you” (14:32).

Such verses teach us that according to the Islamic notion the natural order is not in opposition to God

and His laws. Rather, it is regarded as part of creation and God's divine order. Hence, belief in God and His infinite power does not imply an attitude of disregard towards nature. Neither should man's belief in God's infinite power result in holding him back from its scientific understanding or practical acceptance of nature nor should concern with nature result in a disbelief in God.

The scientific knowledge of a believer in God is similar to the scientific knowledge of a disbeliever, both in theory and in practice. In understanding nature and harnessing its forces they both proceed hand in hand. They differ only in so far that the man of science believing in God does not imprison himself within the bounds of nature although he is engaged in scientific research and technical application. For him nature is a mirror in which he sees God, its Creator. The disbelieving man of science on the other hand is— so engrossed with nature that he cannot penetrate its veil and reach beyond it to its Creator.

Miracles

Even believing in miracles does not affect the work of a Muslim scientist, because they are extremely rare occurring in keeping with their particular order only when necessary. The ratio of the events to natural ones is less than even one in a billion and it is an accepted principle in the methodology that such exceptions do not affect the value of a scientific law or its technical application. Therefore, belief in miracles does not imply a rejection of nature and vice versa.

Servants Of God

Nature and its numerous active elements serve God. The staggering order of nature is an emanation of God's will. All natural phenomena, results of causes, actions and reactions of a material and natural kind are at the same time a ray of God's omnipotence, omniscience and His divine will because natural causes are at God's command eternally.

Endless Universe

Verses from the Holy Qur'an openly proclaim that the world in which we live is endless.

“If you count God's blessings, you shall never number them” (16: 18).

Further, God is incessantly in the act of creation, increasing creation as He wills.

“He increases in the creation as He will. Allah has power over all things” (35: 1).

Therefore, man's progress in science and technology with an eye to using the limitless resources of the universe can never come to a halt and the door of work and endeavour will always be left open.

Fate And Free Will

The teachings of Islam concerning free will, predestination and immortality lay great stress on strengthening man's will to work and try correctly against a background of correct thinking, using up his immense capacity for knowledge, correct judgment and initiative which God had endowed in him, on the one hand and increase his capacity of endurance and resistance against difficulties and tribulations, normally occurring in life on the other hand.

Such teachings are opposed to all manner of indolence, and fatalism when man is faced with natural and social difficulties and frowns upon those who are not robust and possess no self-assurance when faced with the bitter facts of life.

Islam, Modern Science And Technology

From what has already been discussed it is quite clear that Islam is not only not opposed to scientific and technological progress, on the contrary, it encourages it, laying stress only on two points:

1. Scientific, technological and social progress shall not result in man waxing proud and thereby disregarding his Creator.
2. This endeavour and progress shall be utilized to better the condition of men and never be used in propagating sin or to buttress the foundations of cruelty and oppression.

Prophecy

Man's thought soars above the clouds in problems concerning nature and he can expect increasing progress of his faculties. It is precisely for this reason that God's messengers have had no special functions there. But in order to solve problems beyond the realm of nature, and to gain an insight into the afterlife and man's ultimate goal, he is sorely in need of guidance from God.

The succour God gives men and the guidance He sends down upon them is through men to whom He makes revelation, ordaining them to guide their fellows and to teach men what has been revealed to them. They are the prophets.

The teachings of the prophets are neither the result of scientific research nor that of personal experience, but God's teachings which are sent down to them through revelation.

“And He does not speak out of caprice” (53:3).

“It is nought but a revelation revealed” (53:4).

“Taught him by one terrible in power” (53:5).

Right Estimation Of The Prophets

The Holy Qur'an from time to time reminds us that the prophets are men in their substance and they are distinct from others owing to their ability to receive and pass on revelations in order to lead men. In other aspects they do not differ from other human beings. Exactly like others, they are born, eat, drink, sleep, procreate, rear children, and live their span of life, and then pass away. The Holy Qur'an says of Muhammad:

“Say, I am only a man the like of you, it is revealed to me that your God is the only God, so whoever he hopes for encounter with his Lord, shall work righteously, and in the worship of his Lord admit no one as His partner” (18: 110).

Islamic teaching concerning all messengers of God, among them Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses and Jesus is the same. They are all men raised to the station of prophecy and their only distinction is that they receive God's revelations to hand over to their fellowmen.

Miracles By Prophets

The Holy Qur'an speaks, too, of miracles worked by the prophets, but in many verses it is stressed that to work miracles is not left at their discretion.

They do not possess an extra faculty to those we own, thus working miracle on request.

Those opposed to Islam constantly requested miracles from the Prophet. They would say that if he was truly a prophet of God, he ought to be able to do extraordinary things without further ado. The Prophet would reply: “It is not left to me to perform miracles at your caprice. “

The miracles you have heard of God's prophets are God's work performed exceptionally when conditions have rendered them necessary, regardless of the personal inclination of the prophet concerned. Accordingly, miracles do not raise a prophet above the station of other men^{[16](#)}.

Science, Reason And Revelation

Before coming to know the prophets of God we have only one source of knowledge, experiment and thought. science and reason. Once we have known the messengers of God and got sure that they utter nothing but from God we have gained a new source to realize the truth, i. e. the teachings of the prophets which originate from the revelation. Man has no better source of acquainting himself with God, the problems of the hereafter and a way of life both pleasing his God and resulting in eternal happiness.

Believing In And Honouring All Prophets

The Holy Qur'an openly proclaims that Islam is not the creed of Muhammad alone; it is the religion of all the prophets of God. Because Islam, which means surrendering to the truth, is accepting the teachings of God, acquaintance with God and obeying Him and being aware of selfishness and bias in these matters.

Accordingly, Islam is not only the creed of the prophets but it is the religion of men seeking the truth. This is why Muslims respect all prophets, and their scriptures, and believe in them.

“The messenger believes in what was sent down to him from his Lord, and the believers; each one believes in God and His angels and in His books and His messengers (and says): ‘we make no distinction between any one of His Messengers: and they say: ‘We hear and obey. Our Lord, grant us Thy forgiveness; unto Thee is the homecoming’ (2:285).

Deviation

The teachings of the messengers of God were gradually tainted by impure hands and various superstitions introduced. Matters would go so far that even qualified scholars were not able to distinguish the true teachings of the prophets after hard labour and scholarship because those ignorant friends as well as foes with ill intentions had tampered with the sources of religion and even with the divine scriptures.

Under such conditions the only remedy was to send a new prophet to whom revelation would be made again and thus the divine truths would be made available anew. The Holy Qur'an has in the course of relating the stories of most prophets explained this point.

Muhammad And The Holy Qur'an

This state of affairs was renewed in the seventh century. If anyone sincerely sought after the teachings of Abraham, Moses and Jesus or the other prophets of God, it was no longer possible for him to attain to the truth, because there was no reliable source at hand. Neither the Pentateuch had a clever history nor the Gospels or the teachings of the other prophets. These books had been tampered with and this had rendered them valueless. At this time Muhammad was raised by God to accept His revelations and hand them over to mankind.

According to the unquestionable evidence of history, the verses of the Holy Qur'an which Muhammad as prophet delivered from God had an entirely new and miraculous style which was inimitable. This feature was effective in guarding the Holy Qur'an from alteration. Moreover, these verses, named the Holy Qur'an, were made available to everybody and spread rapidly.

This rapid spreading of The Holy Qur'an during 1334 years since the death of Muhammad has also protected the Holy Qur'an from all the causes of alteration and tampering. It is today available as it was revealed fourteen centuries ago, without the slightest difference in its innumerable copies. Having such a source book of high authority is a distinction of Islam not shared by any other religion, making it possible for anyone at any time and place to understand it directly and immediately protecting himself from any error in its understanding.

The Afterlife

One of the teachings of the prophets is that man's existence does not cease with death. Death is only the end of the period of man's struggle and Endeavour.

During this period, he has to find out for himself with his own judgment the right path from the wrong and decide upon his course. He finds his conditions during this period in a state of flux and seeks to preserve it, if good, and to alter it for the better, if bad, With the advent of death. change gives way to eternity.

From then onwards his state is unalterable: it will be what he has made of it in his period of evaluation and endeavour and the afterlife is where he achieves the fruit of his struggle during the previous period. This is Islamic teaching about life and death and the hereafter.

“On that day shall men be scattered and see their works” (99:6).

“And who has done an atom weight of good shall see it” (99:7).

“And who has done an atom weight of evil shall see it” (99:8).

Paradise And Hell

What is paradise? It is the eternal home of the blessed and the blissful and of peace, a home which the righteous have prepared for themselves during their lifetime by honesty and sincerity and God pleasing endeavour.

What is hell? The abode of eternal pain and punishment which evildoers have built for themselves by taking the wrong path, doing evil and oppression and spreading wrong doing.

Other Teachings Of Islam

What has been said heretofore are the basic teachings of Islam. Islam has a lot of detailed teachings in other fields. On the one hand they depend on these basic teachings and on the other hand on individual, family and social needs of men spiritually as well as physically.

Prayer, fasting, the Hajj pilgrimage, struggle and endeavour in making known God's religion and relieving

His servants from oppression, supervising government, attempting to establish a just and true social and economic order, love of fellow-men and helping the needy and helpless, orphans and the poor, truth and honesty, purity and a constant effort in attaining physical and spiritual hygiene form some aspects of this teaching.

Their detailed description cannot be expected in one or two short talks. I hope by means of numerous talks or printed information about Islam, which we will place at your disposal, you will get acquainted with them.

[1.](#) Refer to 39:62 & 59:24.

[2.](#) Refer to 2:29 & 6:59.

[3.](#) Refer to 2:256 & 40:20.

[4.](#) Refer to 42:11 & 67:19.

[5.](#) Refer to 2:213 & 28:56.

[6.](#) Refer to 3:150 & 8:40.

[7.](#) Refer to 2:225 & 35:41.

[8.](#) Refer to 9:117 & 82:6.

[9.](#) Refer to 39:53 & 4:110.

[10.](#) Refer to 14:8 & 31:12.

[11.](#) Refer to 20:7 & 67:13.

[12.](#) Refer to 2:186 & 3:38.

[13.](#) Refer to 3:182; 99:7, 99:8.

[14.](#) Refer to 50:16; 57:4; 55:78.

[15.](#) The 91st verse of the 6th sura reads as follows:

“They did not esteem Allah according to His value when they said: 'Allah has not sent anything down to man'. Say: who then has sent the book which Moses brought as a light and guidance for mankind, but you have made of it sheers of paper which you show while you conceal much” (6:91).

A group of Jews who had dealing with the Meccans heard that a messenger had arisen from among the Qur'an's saying: 'God has revealed to me so that I may rise up against those who take partners unto Him, and to rise up against ignorance and oppression. I have been ordained by Him to place within the reach of men the divine truths, so that all may know God and the right way of life pleasing Him, and to deliver them from error. Accepting the truth that Muhammad was the prophet of God was for many reasons unpalatable to those Jews, so that they attempted to sabotage the progress and spread of Islam from many directions and eventually decided to fight Islam.

They employed various methods in their struggle. One way was to cast doubt in the humble minds of the Arabs. Among other things, they said that it is impossible that God should reveal His message to a man and it has not been known of God that He has done so. In reply to this the The Holy Qur'an says: 'What about the book brought by Moses? From where did it come to him? Is it not true that exactly like the The Holy Qur'an it was sent down as a revelation on one who had been chosen for prophecy. so that he may guide men. Verily, Moses too was a man to whom a Holy Book had been revealed as well, and that illusory claim – 'God never sent a revelation to man' – is based on ignorance.

The unwise claim by the Jews was directly related to the problem of the revelation, but The Holy Qur'an has considered it as a result of their wrong conception of God.

[16.](#) See The Holy Qur'an 6:109; 17: 90–93 and many other verses.

[1] [1]

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